

Three Little Pigs

Once upon a time, three little pigs said goodbye to their mother and went out into the world to build their own lives. The first little pig, who loved to play more than work, quickly threw together a house made entirely of loose straw and went off to spend his afternoon singing. The second little pig wanted to relax too, so he gathered fallen branches and quickly constructed a simple house of sticks. However, the third little pig was wise and patient; knowing that danger could lurk in the woods, he put in long hours of hard labor to build a sturdy, reliable house made of heavy clay bricks and mortar.

Before long, a hungry Big Bad Wolf came creeping through the forest and spotted the flimsy house of straw. He knocked loudly on the door and cried, "Little pig, little pig, let me come in!" to which the frightened pig replied, "No, no, by the hair on my chinny-chin-chin!" The wolf grinned, warning, "Then I'll huff, and I'll puff, and I'll blow your house in!" With a mighty breath, the wolf blew the straw house completely away, forcing the terrified little pig to sprint as fast as his legs could carry him straight to his brother's house of sticks.

The wolf followed the scent to the second house and knocked again, demanding entry from the two brothers. When they defiantly refused, the wolf inhaled deeply and let out a furious blast of air that shattered the house of sticks into splinters. Panicked and squealing, the two pigs scrambled through the undergrowth and burst into the third brother's brick home, slamming the heavy wooden door just in time. The wolf arrived and huffed, and he puffed, and he blew until he was completely blue in the face, but the solid brick walls didn't even shake. Realizing he couldn't blow the house down, the furious wolf climbed onto the roof to slide down the chimney, but the clever third pig was ready. He lit a roaring fire and placed a giant pot of boiling water in the hearth, so when the wolf slid down, he crashed straight into the scalding pot. With a painful yelp, the wolf shot back up the chimney and fled deep into the forest, leaving the three little pigs to live safely and happily together in the sturdy brick house forever after.